

CLASS - 12th

SUBJECT - ENGLISH

PROSE + POETRY + STORY OF ENGLISH

CLASS 12TH BIHAR BOARD – ENGLISH (RAINBOW PART 2)

CHAPTER 10: INDIA THROUGH A TRAVELLER'S EYES (BY PEARL S. BUCK)

 CHAPTER SUMMARY (IN 50 WORDS)

"India Through a Traveller's Eyes" is an admirable travel essay by Pearl S. Buck. She expresses her deep love for India, describing the dedication of young intellectuals and the clean, deeply religious life of poor peasants. She praises Indian hospitality and criticizes British rule for causing massive poverty.

 15 IMPORTANT SHORT SUBJECTIVE QUESTIONS & ANSWERS

Q1. Why did Pearl S. Buck want to visit India?

Ans: Pearl S. Buck wanted to visit India not to see monuments like the Taj Mahal, but to meet and understand the young intellectuals in cities and the poor peasants in villages.

Q2. What was the main grievance of the young Indian intellectuals against British rule?

Ans: Their main grievance was that British rule had systematically ruined their country, crushed their freedom, and offered no real opportunities for educated youth.

Q3. How does the author describe the life of poor Indian peasants?

Ans: She describes Indian peasants as hard-working, deeply religious, and extremely poor people who lived in mud houses but maintained remarkable personal cleanliness.

Q4. What did Pearl S. Buck observe about Indian cleanliness and eating habits?

Ans: She observed that Indians were exceptionally clean. They washed their hands and feet before meals and ate off fresh, green banana leaves instead of dishes.

Q5. Who was the leader who had a massive influence on both intellectuals and peasants in India?

Ans: Mahatma Gandhi was the leader who held a massive influence, uniting both educated people and poor farmers under the non-violent struggle for freedom.

Q6. Why does the author blame British rule for the poverty of Indian villages?

Ans: She blames British rule because the administration extracted heavy taxes from the poor farmers but spent almost nothing on their health, education, or development.

Q7. What shocked the author about the life expectancy in India at that time?



CLASS - 12th SUBJECT - ENGLISH PROSE + POETRY + STORY OF ENGLISH

Ans: She was shocked to learn that the average life expectancy of an Indian citizen was tragically low, being only twenty-seven years.

Q8. How did the author experience Indian hospitality during her visit?

Ans: She experienced immense warmth and hospitality. Even the poorest families welcomed her like a royal guest and shared whatever little food they had.

Q9. What did the author notice about the religious tolerance of Indian people?

Ans: She noticed high religious tolerance, observing that people of different faiths lived together in harmony, deeply rooted in their spiritual values.

Q10. How did the family system in Indian villages impress Pearl S. Buck?

Ans: She was highly impressed by the joint family system, where elders were deeply respected and family members cared for one another with love.

Q11. What was the difference between the color of Kashmiri people and South Indians?

Ans: She observed that Kashmiri people had a fair, auburn skin tone similar to Europeans, while South Indians had a beautiful, dark skin tone.

Q12. What did the author learn about the role of women in Indian society?

Ans: She learned that despite facing social hardships, Indian women possessed great inner strength, dignity, and played a vital role in family management.

Q13. Why did the author say that the real strength of India lies in its villages?

Ans: She said so because the vast majority of the population lived in villages, preserving the core cultural values, resilience, and spiritual spirit of the nation.

Q14. What did the author think of the English language spoken by educated Indians?

Ans: She was deeply impressed by their command over English, noting that they spoke it beautifully, fluently, and with excellent grammatical precision.

Q15. What is the final conclusion of Pearl S. Buck about India?

Ans: Her final conclusion is that India is a land of great cultural wealth, deep human values, and a nation destined to have a glorious independent future.

 50 OBJECTIVE QUESTIONS (QUESTION & OPTIONS IN SINGLE LINE)

1. 'India Through a Traveller's Eyes' is written by: (A) Bertrand Russell (B) Pearl S. Buck (C) H.E. Bates (D) Anton Chekhov

2. Pearl S. Buck was an eminent _____ writer.: (A) British (B) American (C) Indian (D) African

3. Pearl S. Buck was awarded the Nobel Prize for Literature in the year: (A) 1930 (B) 1938 (C) 1950 (D) 1964



CLASS - 12th

SUBJECT - ENGLISH

PROSE + POETRY + STORY OF ENGLISH

4. Pearl S. Buck was raised in which country by her missionary parents?: (A) India (B) China (C) Japan (D) France
5. This text 'India Through a Traveller's Eyes' is a/an: (A) Short story (B) Travel essay / extract (C) Drama (D) Poem
6. The author didn't come to India to see the Taj Mahal or the: (A) Red Fort (B) Fatehpur Sikri / monuments (C) Ganges (D) Himalayas
7. Pearl S. Buck came to India to meet two groups of people: intellectuals and: (A) kings (B) peasants / farmers (C) businessmen (D) soldiers
8. The young intellectuals of India were found mostly in the: (A) forests (B) cities / universities (C) ships (D) foreign lands
9. The peasants and poor farmers lived in the remote: (A) cities (B) villages (C) factories (D) mountains
10. The main reason for the intense poverty in India was the misrule of the: (A) Mughals (B) Britishers (C) French (D) Americans
11. The average life expectancy of an Indian during the author's visit was only: (A) 27 years (B) 40 years (C) 50 years (D) 60 years
12. The author found that Indian intellectuals were deeply: (A) happy with the British (B) bitter and restless (C) uneducated (D) lazy
13. The leader who galvanized and united the entire Indian population was: (A) Pt. Nehru (B) Mahatma Gandhi (C) Bhagat Singh (D) Subhas Chandra Bose
14. The Kashmiri people have a skin color that resembles the: (A) Africans (B) Fair Europeans (C) Chinese (D) West Indians
15. According to the author, the people of the South are beautifully: (A) white (B) dark-skinned (C) yellow (D) red
16. The author ate her food in a traditional village home off fresh, green: (A) plastic plates (B) banana leaves (C) silver dishes (D) wooden trays
17. Before starting a meal, Indians strictly wash their: (A) clothes (B) hands and feet (C) houses (D) hair
18. The food served in the Indian village was completely: (A) non-vegetarian (B) vegetarian (C) frozen (D) raw
19. Pearl S. Buck noted that the master of the house ate: (A) with her (B) after she had finished eating (C) before her (D) in the kitchen alone
20. The author praises the Indian people for their innate sense of: (A) pride (B) cleanliness and hospitality (C) anger (D) isolation
21. The parallel situation of poverty in India was compared by the author to: (A) China (B) America (C) England (D) Russia
22. The author states that the colonization of India caused absolute economic: (A) growth (B) ruin / drain (C) success (D) trade



CLASS - 12th SUBJECT - ENGLISH PROSE + POETRY + STORY OF ENGLISH

23. The text states that the English spoken by young Indian intellectuals was: (A) very poor (B) excellent and fluent (C) funny (D) broken
24. Indian religion, according to the author, is a living part of their daily: (A) business (B) life and conduct (C) politics (D) studies
25. Pearl S. Buck wrote a famous novel about Chinese peasant life named: (A) Distant Drum (B) The Good Earth (C) My Country (D) Freedom
26. The author's host in the Indian village was a relatively poor: (A) landlord (B) peasant / farmer family (C) school teacher (D) doctor
27. The author observed that children in Indian villages were often: (A) overfed (B) undernourished / thin (C) highly wealthy (D) wearing suits
28. The multi-generational family structure found in India is known as the: (A) nuclear family (B) joint family system (C) single parenting (D) clan structure
29. The author asserts that India has taught the world the lesson of: (A) violence (B) non-violence and tolerance (C) communism (D) imperialism
30. The word 'Intellectuals' refers to people who are highly: (A) athletic (B) educated and thoughtful (C) wealthy (D) aggressive
31. The author notes that British officials had no real sympathy for the: (A) English language (B) Indian masses (C) rich kings only (D) trade
32. The houses in the villages visited by the author were made of: (A) glass (B) mud and thatch (C) marble (D) steel
33. Pearl S. Buck felt a deep sense of _____ towards the Indian people.: (A) hatred (B) empathy and affection (C) jealousy (D) indifference
34. The text demonstrates that Indian civilization is exceptionally: (A) young (B) ancient and resilient (C) fading (D) westernized
35. The author was surprised to see the high level of respect given to: (A) money (B) elderly people / parents (C) weapons (D) British uniforms
36. The tone of Pearl S. Buck throughout this travel essay is: (A) highly critical of India (B) appreciative and objective (C) comedic (D) superstitious
37. Young Indians wanted complete and unconditional: (A) taxation (B) independence / Swaraj (C) British citizenship (D) machinery
38. The author points out that real India cannot be understood by staying in: (A) mud houses (B) luxury hotels of big cities (C) villages (D) templates
39. What did the author find in the eyes of the Indian peasants?: (A) Greed (B) Contentment and deep dignity (C) Fear (D) Sleepiness
40. The author notes that the Indian peasant is much more alert than the peasant of: (A) America (B) Europe (C) Africa (D) none of these
41. The underlying theme of the lesson is a celebration of Indian: (A) military power (B) humanity and



CLASS - 12th SUBJECT - ENGLISH PROSE + POETRY + STORY OF ENGLISH

culture (C) industrial growth (D) weather

42. The author states that the pride of an Indian is rooted in his: (A) cash (B) ancient heritage and culture (C) weapons (D) car

43. British rule failed to provide basic facilities like clean drinking water and: (A) cars (B) healthcare / schools (C) cinema (D) internet

44. The essay reveals that the author's background made her open to: (A) war (B) diverse cultures (C) capitalism only (D) isolation

45. The people of India welcomed the American author with open: (A) weapons (B) arms and hearts (C) anger (D) doubts

46. The author observed that Indian life is deeply colored by: (A) industrialization (B) spirituality and faith (C) western clothing (D) sports

47. The name of the chapter indicates it is a perspective of a: (A) politician (B) foreign traveller (C) soldier (D) trader

48. In the text, the author describes the Indian village life as remarkably: (A) chaotic (B) disciplined and clean (C) violent (D) rich

49. The author's view of India helped change the Western perception of the: (A) country (B) language (C) maps (D) flags

50. Pearl S. Buck's essay remains a classic testament to global: (A) business (B) human connection and empathy (C) conflicts (D) politics

WHERE EXCELLENCE IS
TRADITION

SUJIT KUMAR

